Ethics for people and the planet reading cards

Pink supported print

Ethics asks for reasons

Ethics is thinking about right and wrong. It asks how we should act and why. A choice can affect people, other animals and the world around us. We can ask who benefits, who might face harm and what information we need. A claim needs evidence. We should not treat a guess as a fact. People may disagree about the best choice while still listening carefully and treating each other with respect.

Different sources of reasons

Some Christians use stewardship to explain a duty to care for God's creation. Sikh teaching values equality and seva, or selfless service. These can support care for people and a fair welcome. Humanists use reason, evidence and concern for wellbeing when weighing choices. People within these worldviews can reach different decisions. A reason gives us something to consider. It does not mean everyone in a tradition must choose the same option in every case.

An invented club dilemma

A made-up club plans a small display. It has twenty clean sheets left from an earlier activity. Four sheets have writing on one side. The club needs fifteen sheets for new work. Option A is to buy a fresh pack and throw the old sheets away. Option B is to reuse suitable sheets and keep the rest. Option C is to cancel the display so no one can take part. These are invented options for discussion. No money, real purchase or waste handling is involved.

Investigate before choosing

The club should check that the sheets are safe, readable and suitable for the task. Using the blank sides may reduce waste. It should also check that every learner has a clear page they can use. A pupil with a particular access need may need a different format. A fair choice considers that need. A good judgement might favour reusing suitable sheets while asking an adult for any extra format needed. It explains how the choice helps people and reduces waste. It also admits what still needs checking. We are investigating reasons, not choosing which worldview is best. Use the invented club rather than private experiences.

Learn about these ideas without sharing your own belief. An adult can reread a short part.

Cards to discuss

A

Buy a new pack and throw away all twenty clean sheets.

B

Reuse suitable sheets, keep spares and check everyone's access needs.

C

Cancel the display so no one can take part.

D

Some Christians see care for creation as stewardship.

E

Sikh equality and seva can support a plan that serves and includes others.

F

Humanists may weigh evidence and likely effects on wellbeing.